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Editor's Note

Dear Reader,

Many, many years ago, when I was searching for excuses to text my childhood crush, my more "experienced" friends advised me that the first step to any relationship was asking questions. The point here isn't my personal life – you can guess for yourself whether that went well or not. The point here is the often overlooked virtue of inquiry.

The art of interrogation does not refer to the scientific solution to a problem. No, it is more sentimental than that. In fact, a question is a very bare, honest form of emotion; it is proof that you care. It is beautiful because it is a voluntary search for more. A question is evidence that you willingly spent your leisure time to think more about that enigmatic chemistry problem. A question is an embodiment of affection when Mom asks how your day was. A question is an indirect way of saying that you are dissatisfied with just learning the big picture — you burn with the desire for detail. "Caress the detail, the divine detail," said Vladimir Nabokov.

But it takes courage to admit ignorance. Especially in the Korean atmosphere, and perhaps also in KMLA. Sometimes we fear how others will view us: whether this would make us look silly and non-composed. At other times we are just too busy to care, or we are too bothered to try asking. For this edition, Minjok Herald has decided to speak for you instead. We asked you for the little questions you've always wanted to ask about KMLA but didn't. And your responses, thankfully, have been explosive. All your enigmas have been investigated and melted into our articles, ranging from school facilities to tales about cohabitant dormitory ghosts. We think your questions deserve to have a voice. We hope you enjoy the articles as much as we did writing them.

My term as Editor-in-Chief is finally coming to a close after what feels like ages, and I am filled with mixed emotions of long-sought freedom, pride, and regret. I would like to extend gratitude to my wonderful teachers who have guided and motivated me to reach farther. And to my beloved staff, writers, and designers: you all deserve a pat on the back for working with a somewhat tyrannical editor. Although I do not show it much, I love you all (well, at least most of you). I think I can finally die with all my publications buried with me in my coffin.

Ahn Se Bin
Editor-in-Chief
July 18th , 2016

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Snap









shots





A Road to Remember

On June 26th, a ceremony celebrating the 20th anniversary of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy was held at the Seoul COEX Grand Ballroom. The 20th year has been symbolic to those who know the principles of this school, outlined by the founder himself. 20 stands for the graduates' assimilation into various sectors of society; 20 stands for the students' return to their alma mater as fully grown adults; 20 stands for the time it took KMLA to prove that its adventurous methods weren't just created out of whim, but a valuable turning point in Korean education.

With invitations being given out to graduates from the first to eighteenth wave, a ceremony of such grandeur had been yet unheard of at KMLA. A task force composed of 6 teachers and the Administration Office was created in September 2015 to plan this festivity. Everything from contacting alumni, coordinating the date and location, advertising the event, and scheduling the programs was done by this task force. The Office of Public Relations also helped by creating a video clip commemorating the anniversary.

First, there was time for the graduates to share snippets of their lives after graduation. After that, there were performances held by both students and graduates. Samuchim, the school's samulnori club, performed, and Kandles, a relatively new cheerleading club, was introduced to the graduates. As for the graduates, the band Jeon Bum-Seon and the Yangbans, centered around the eponymous 12th Wave alumni Jeon Bum-Seon, also performed. The graduates then officially declared themselves and the entire student body as KMLAians who will always honor the "KMLA spirit."

"Now, it is our turn"

Ms. Hwang So-Hee, a graduate herself, had been in charge of contacting multiple alumni and interviewing them before the ceremony. She expressed a desire to relay their common words of advice. "The KMLA of today wasn't just magically built in a day," she says. Our seniors, especially the 1st to 6th wavers who experienced the tough times of a newly born school, felt especially strongly about this statement. The school wasn't a given; it was created with the hard effort of the faculty and the students, who worked together to achieve something out of nothing. KMLA is worth protecting.

Being the recipient of public attention, KMLA probably will have difficult times, and the students themselves might sometimes wonder whether KMLA is worth the hype. But we must overcome these doubts and difficulties to present our underclassmen with a better school, keeping in mind what our upperclassmen have gone through for us. Now, it is our turn to maintain this precious gift.

Park Shin-Young
Junior writer, 20th Wave



The Ballot Assumes a New Look

In early February, worries that the 20th Student Council election was flawed quietly spread around the school. To be specific, the 19th Student Council electoral commission had set arbitrary standards for determining invalid votes. This was especially problematic when the votes of two candidates were tied as in the 20th Student Council election, since each vote became very meaningful. Concerns were raised that because certain members of the commission had explicitly discussed their preferred candidates while counting the votes, the counting process might have been influenced, and consequently the election results might be altered.

With distrust towards student government culminating, the 19th electoral commission responded to the matter by uploading a Facebook post on February 4th. They apologized for making biased statements during the ballot count. However, they argued that the election result was not in any way affected by their bias, for the candidates who would be given the invalid votes were decided by a show of hands. Although the committee quelled claims of corruption, this controversy was enough to raise concerned voices about the propriety of the election process. Many argued that leaving the determination of invalid votes entirely up to the subjective judgment of the student council was unwise. The need for change was apparent.

A quick response was necessary because the 21st Student Council election was coming up soon. Meetings were held between the 20th Student Council, Ms. Jeong Sun-Hee, and Mr. Kim Myung-Soon, both teachers from the Office of Student Guidance. It was concluded that there would be a change in the stamps, design of ballots, and standards of distinguishing invalid votes.

> "The need for change is apparent."

New official voting stamps were ordered to replace the unofficial marker caps which were previously used. The ballot papers became bigger with empty spaces between each column to prevent smearing and marking mistakes. A clear set of standards to determine invalid votes was announced to voters through the Facebook group. Meanwhile, the student press and the Department of Audit and Inspection were invited on Election Day to monitor the overall ballot-counting process, as a move to enhance the credibility of the election results.

The results of the change were stunning. There was a dramatic decrease in the number of invalid votes, with less than ten discovered for each council. The ballot count was finished smoothly without controversy. To create a more proper voting environment, the council attempted to order new ballot boxes and dividing screens to imitate the real national election rooms. This idea was met with enthusiastic support from the teachers with the promise of necessary funding. However, time fell short of making these ideas come true. Thus, remodeling the election room will most likely become the responsibility of the 21st Student Council.

KMLA's election process is unique in Korean standards. The process takes up to three weeks with official candidate pledges, mandatory question and answer sessions, and a student press conference. However, all this time and effort will be useless if the elections aren't respected by the student body. President of the 20th Executive Council Koo Min-Seok urged, "I wish the student body can reaffirm pride in our school's student autonomy through these new efforts to improve the election process."

Yoon Ji-Hoe
Staff writer, 19th Wave

election

Dr. Jeong Jin-Gon, A Candle for KMLA

One of the biggest news in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy this year was the arrival of our new headmaster Dr. Jeong Jin-Gon. After being officially inaugurated as headmaster on March 1st, Dr. Jeong has been extremely active in reaching out to the students and bringing changes in the school. Minjok Herald was able to meet with Dr. Jeong and hear a few things from him in regard to KMLA and the plans he has. Additionally, Minjok Herald was able to hear some student opinions about the new headmaster so far, and what they hope for him to accomplish.

MH What was your first impression of KMLA?

It was ten years ago when I first visited KMLA. Back then, I was very impressed by the school buildings and the classes held in English. When I look at the buildings now, they seem too old. The dorm is too old and worn, unfit for the leaders of the future. The students use Korean so naturally, despite the EOP posters all over the school. The Founder asserted that the purpose of KMLA is not getting into Seoul National University, but many seem to think the opposite now… I think the Founder would be disappointed.

MH You've been very active in getting to know the students. What is your impression of the students?

When I first came to KMLA, I was disappointed on many fronts. But after talking with quite a number of teachers, I felt hope. I could see that they were skilled and loved the students, and that they had a sense of dignity and pride about KMLA. I realized that it was too early to despair. I was also able to talk with the students — I've often dined with the students before I started my official term. They seem very intelligent, good, bright, and they are very good at English. The students made me think, "Oh, this place is still a good school."

MH What are some strengths of KMLA?

First, the method of teaching is very different from other schools. I've visited hundreds of schools and tried to visit schools in foreign countries whenever I had the chance. Reflecting on those experiences, KMLA's classes and their content and methods are very different. In KMLA, classes adjust to the students' levels and the teachers use different materials such as thesis papers and foreign books. Also, classes are carried on by students' debates. I believe that this is KMLA's most outstanding characteristic. Besides those, students exercise in the morning. It's not as intense as in the past but it makes students attain strong, healthy bodies. Students are also able to learn traditional music and culture through kayageum and daegeum. It's a very unique, educational atmosphere.

MH On the other hand, what are some drawbacks of KMLA? (And how do you plan to deal with them?)

The school's services and facilities are old and sparse. We are planning on a complete renovation of the dormitory with an accumulation of donations. Thankfully, many graduates and parents have contributed to this sum throughout the years. The re-painting of the walls and doors will take place. I also plan on remodeling the interior of the individual rooms, especially the wallpaper and the lights within this year. The remodeling of the freshmen's rooms could be done while they are gone for the Vision Trip, while the juniors' and seniors' rooms will be remodeled during summer vacation. Additionally, to alleviate the students' burden having to go from class to class during a very limited amount of time, the buildings' formats will be organized accordingly. There is much to fix in the gymnasium, science laboratories, and library as well.

MH What changes have you made in the school so far? What are some specific, short-term goals you are thinking of accomplishing now?

It has only been a month, so I plan on changing things little by little from now on. Students have told me many things, for example the planting of more flower trees. Our school has a lot of things worth displaying, so starting from August I plan on showcasing more of our school's history and pride. Such exhibitions already exist in many esteemed high schools in other countries. The students also don't have many places to rest, despite the fact



that they generally don't have enough time to sleep due to classes, homework, and morning exercise. So I am trying to make a place for the students to rest in lieu of the Dasan and Chungmoo lobbies.

MH What are some of your long term goals?

The reason this school was founded was to educate leaders who would become the backbone of our country. Currently our nation is experiencing a financial crisis due to the collapse of many critical industries. Also, the average age of our population is getting steadily older, which leads to a decrease in production levels. We need gifted, entrepreneurial people like Mark Zuckerberg and Bill Gates to create new industries; we need to create these creative and brave people who will support the future of our country, and the only school that can do that in Korea is KMLA. I plan not to receive a salary while I am here. I plan on becoming a candle for KMLA, in adherence to our school motto. My dream is that KMLA will make Korea great again. I'm pretty sure I am not alone in this sentiment; this is most likely the society's dream and vision as well. I am confident that KMLA has the potential to achieve its ideals. I will do all I can to educate students who will sacrifice themselves for society, country, and the world.

The new headmaster has been spotted several times dining with students in the cafeteria, actively conversing with them. Furthermore, Dr. Jeong is very active around campus, sometimes visiting classes and often talking to students. True, some students were bewildered at the sudden new presence in their lives, but generally the reactions so far have been very positive: "He gives us a lot of feedback, so we think 'Oh, our opinions are being accepted!'" said one 20th waver. What the student body waits for now is confirmation that their voices are taken into realistic consideration and that he might truly be a candle for KMLA, lighting up the school.

Lee Yung-Seo
Junior Writer, 20th Wave



The Virtue

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of Inquiry

TURE

"The important thing is not to stop questioning," Albert Einstein famously once said. How often do we ask questions? When we first encountered KMLA as freshmen, everything we saw was a surprise and wonder that led to a series of questions. Some of these questions could be answered by teachers and upperclassmen, while others still remain unanswered. After the first month, however, we adjusted ourselves to the new environment and stopped asking questions. In this Feature, Minjok Herald challenges students to continue on with their intellectual curiosity. As you read through the articles, think about the questions you once had in mind. Let's begin with subjects like cafeteria food, abandoned school facilities, and thrilling myths.



Kim Hee-Jin
Junior feature writer, 20th Wave

KMLA Thrillers That Will Make Your Heart Pound

The Dutch Soldier Ghost

Rumors of a handsome Dutch soldier that roams the rooms of the 6th and 7th floor of the dormitory are widely known. According to rumors, anyone who sees this ghost will break his or her leg (literally), because the Dutch soldier also lost his leg in battle.

KMLA, built on a battle site of the Korean Civil War, is said to be on land where many Dutch soldiers died. For this reason, the members of the student council pay a visit to the Netherland War Memorial each year to participate in the commemoration ceremony of the Dutch soldiers who fought in the war. It is assumed that the ghost that haunts KMLA is the spirit of one of those soldiers who died on the battlefield.

Witnesses of the ghost are more often GLPS students and Program Assistants than KMLA students. For the last few waves, witnesses of the Dutch soldier have become scarce whereas sightings at GLPS have been heard continuously.

20th waver Park Ji-Yeon A reported various sightings of the handsome ghost during her stay at GLPS last summer. One of the camp participants came to her, saying that all the books in the room had been ripped page by page during school hours. None of the roommates had entered the room before classes were over. They went through the CCTV record, but there was not a single person who had walked into the room.



Similarly, another student said that everything on the desk had been moved to the floor, and the floor was a mess. All the windows were closed, so it couldn't have been the wind. Once again, the CCTV record showed nothing.

20th waver Yoon Da-Eun said that during her first month of school, she saw a strange shadow in her room at three in the morning. She first thought the shadow was her own, but later realized that the shadow was unusually big and the hair too short to be her own. Various GLPS students and Program Assistants often testified to hearing a man talking in an unidentifiable language at night. Some even saw the ghost standing without one leg.

Perhaps, at least according to traditional folklore, the young participants of GLPS tend to have weaker spirits (also known as "qi") compared to KMLA students. It is a commonly held belief that those with weaker spirits are prone to see ghosts. KMLA students are less likely to meet the ghost since they have strong minds. But if someone does, we do hope that he or she will watch out for their legs.

The Haunted House

There is an abandoned house in the woods behind the school buildings. According to Mr. Eom Se-Yong, who has been with the school since its founding, the Founder used to live there before the school was built, when the grounds were used as a livestock farm. Once the dormitory was built, the Founder moved into the school building, leaving the old house, which is now rumored to be haunted. I, being given the topic of ghost stories, decided that this was a marvelous topic to write about, and set off to see the house for myself with a friend.



Another interesting fact about the haunted house is that it is not a "house," but "houses." Once we climbed through the mass of grass and trees, we reached a flat floor of cement where plants no longer grew. Upon standing there, we saw that there were, in fact, two houses, not one.

They were both built of red bricks and blue roof tiles. They were rather modern buildings, sort of like the English Center without the white paint. The windows were all shattered to pieces and transparent shards were scattered on the inside of the house. Clearly the severe wind that had chilled everyone the night before was responsible for a large part of the scattering.



We went into the house on the left side. The first thing we noticed upon entering the house was that there was an empty chandelier hanging from the half-collapsed ceiling. The well-cut glass pieces, clearly meant to reflect the light to all parts of the room with their many edges, were on the floor. There were only some dozen pieces though, whereas there should have been easily over 50 pieces in order to make up the chandelier. Other pieces could be found nowhere inside or around the two houses.

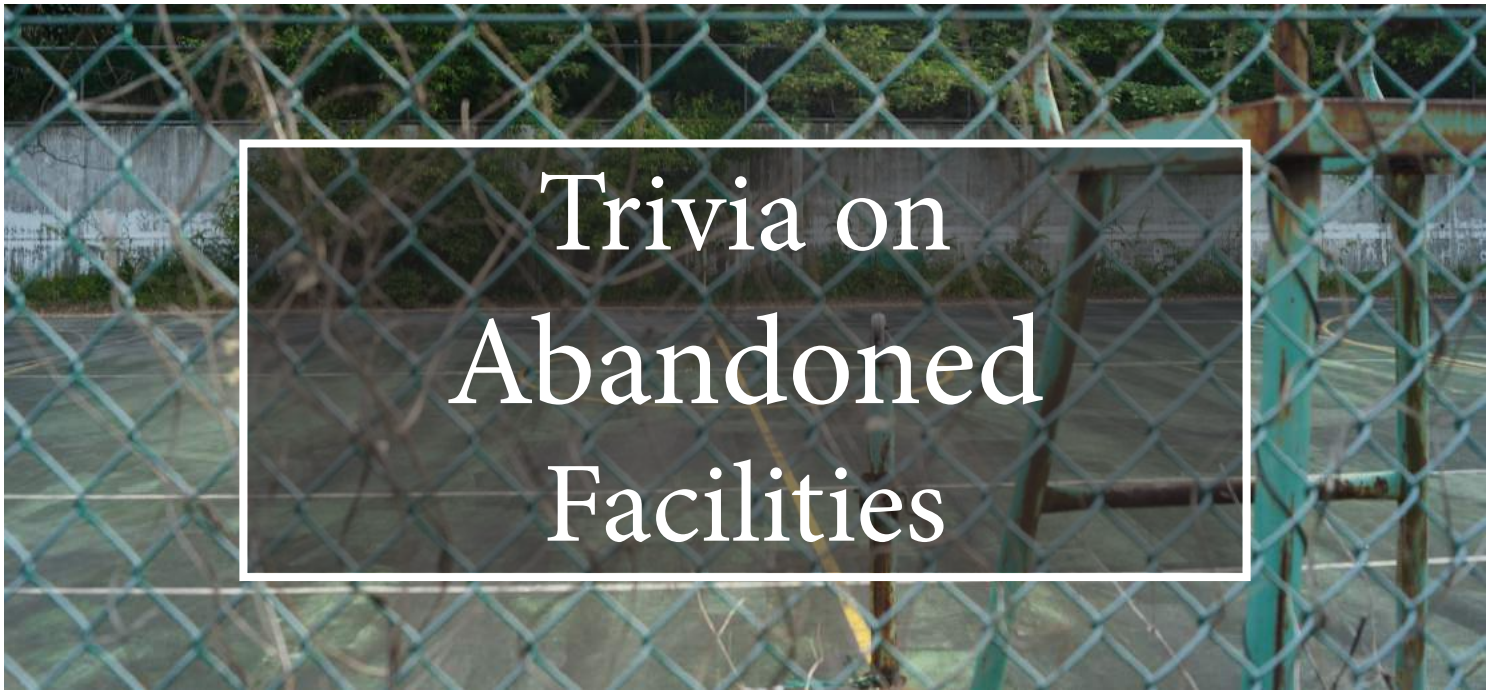
The rest of the ceiling was collapsed. We could not go onto the roof because, well, the roof was half gone. The woods that had previously held up the roof and newly grown trees mingled together to create an eerie atmosphere. Other parts of the house were covered with broken pieces of doors and windows, old furniture and curtains, as was the same with the case with the other house on the right side.

The house on the right side was in a much better state, for the ceiling had not yet collapsed. There was an empty kitchen, an open refrigerator, and dry, broken bowls here and there. Everything was covered in a light film of dust. But for some reason, the plates were eerily clean, indicating that they were either recently used, or were brought into the house recently.

One of the rooms still had a hanging curtain. It was red, like those rich and heavy velveteen curtains seen in Gothic movies, only this did not fall as thickly as such movie curtains, for there were large holes in the middle. It almost seemed as if the curtains were clothes, meant to be worn by the winds.



We further went into the corridor, but the back of the house was covered by trees, so we were unable to find a path that went up to the upper floor. Green leaves and prickly branches seemed to guard the house of secrets never meant to be told. Making our way through a road blocked by plants, we went back down the woods to the school.



Trivia on Abandoned Facilities

KMLA owns a huge campus for a Korean high school - in fact, the largest in the country - that has been continuously morphing over the past 20 years. In the process, many nooks and crannies of our school remain relics of the past, lying around in disuse. Minjok Herald investigated some of these places and learned about their history by interviewing Mr. Choi Gwan-Young, who has been with the school since the very beginning.

1. Abandoned tennis courts

Three tennis courts remain: 1. Beside Changui Hall 2. On the roundabout way to the gym 3. By the track field

The road next to Changui Hall is called the "Road to College" because the Founder had wanted to build a college over the back hill. Having a tennis court on this road may seem bizarre now, but in earlier years the Changui Hall served as the dormitory so it made sense. It now lies unused since the creation of the current dormitory, Deokgo House. The tennis court by the track field wasn't even built until the dorms were moved to Deokgo House in 1999. The school decided to cut down a small hill next to the track field and build a tennis court, which we (seldom) use today.

There is also a fourth tennis court at KMLA, now non-existent. The curious green plain of nothingness situated next to the English Center, better known as the subject of Mr. Garrioch's Photoshop Contest, also used to be a tennis court. Unbeknownst to the students, it now serves as the roof of a small building used by school administrative workers. After the court facilities were removed, the open space was once used to keep native Jindo dogs donated to the school.

Upon asking for the reason behind the (rather excessively) large number of tennis courts, we learned that the Founder was an avid advocate of sports. His favorite sport was golf, but he believed in the general virtue of all sports ranging from baseball to tennis, leading him to create diverse outdoor activity facilities for students. In fact, the ski trips which the current students go on twice a year used to take place every week. There even used to be an ice rink beside the barbecue area!

2. Fountains near Dasan Hall, Chungmoo Hall, and the Culture Center

Rumor: The fountains were stopped because of financial difficulties and safety issues regarding wild animals. Animals occasionally fell into the pools and drowned, leaving behind dead bodies.

Truth: The biggest problem wasn't the danger posed to the animals. When asked about the snakes, rats, and frogs that often fell into the pool, Mr. Alexander Ganse replied, "Most animals can swim, naturally." The more fundamental problem lay in the structural planning. It turned out that the water circulation system wasn't working properly, so people had to manually pump or even bucket water on a regular basis. Obviously, that wasn't efficient. The stagnant water caused green algae proliferation, not the most aesthetic view in fountains, and

soon afterwards started to stink.

Safety issues were also raised, not necessarily regarding the animals, but more about humans. Someone might fall into the pool and get hurt, though no account of such incident was recalled in the interviews. (This is quite ironic considering that the stone floors of the fountains pose a greater threat without the water.) In the past, some of the fifth wavers pushed multiple teachers, including Mr. Park Hyung-Jong, into the water as part of a Teacher's Day celebration or prank. Mr. Park recalled the incident with the following comment: "Back in those days, flinging teachers (especially male teachers) into the fountain was almost like a trend!" Though not always in use, the fountains remained filled with water until the fifth wave, but for the above reasons, the water was pumped out. Although the fountains could always be reactivated, it is inefficient to do so at this point unless a complete structural change is undertaken.

3. Swimming Pool behind Changui Hall

Rumor: Financial problems led to its discontinuation.

Truth: The swimming pool had the same structural error as the fountains - the water was not being properly circulated. At least in the case of the fountains, nobody would be in direct physical contact with the water (at least except Mr. Park Hyung-Jong). But for the swimming pools, since the students would be submerging half-naked in the water, the green algae and odor were even more problematic. It is also true that there were monetary issues. The pool was stopped in 1998 when the school was experiencing financial difficulty.

Water temperature was another huge problem. Because the pool used underground water and water from the valleys, it remained cold even through summer. While it would have been a treat in the summer heat of recent years, back then the average temperature was lower, so the water was too cold for regular use. Meanwhile, animals also enjoyed the swimming pool along with the students. As Mr. Choi Gwan-Young recalls: "I myself went swimming there once or twice, and I encountered frogs swimming beside me."

4. Other Trivia

Rumor: There used to be a skating rink and sauna in the gym's basement.

Truth: The current gym was built with just 90 students in mind, and instead of a skating rink there were shower stalls and baths in the basement. However, since the students preferred to take showers in the dorms, they were removed and the basement was remodeled into the current Taekwondo arena. Although there initially was a plan to build a bigger gym - as large as a sport complex - next to the archery ground, it was deemed infeasible. Apparently the plan included an actual skating rink in the basement, hence the rumor spread.

Chang Seo-Won
Senior feature writer, 19th Wave





Ms. Kim Min-Sun

What to Eat Today

In the stressful KMLA life, perhaps there is nothing more heart-warming as the presence of good food. As important as it is, food is also the subject of many of the students' questions. To provide answers to some of the most popular ones, Minjok Herald interviewed Ms. Kim Min-Sun, KMLA's nutritionist; Ms. Seuk, a renowned vegetarian; and Mr. Baumgardner, someone rumored to never eat.

The Cafeteria Big Shot

MH Hello, Ms. Kim! Many students were surprised about unconventional dishes like buldac-ghetti (MH: a combination of two ramen brands: one with black soybean sauce and the other with chili paste spicy beyond imagination) in our lunch menu. When did you first learn about this recipe?

I first saw buldac-ghetti while supervising a barbeque. Students were fighting over the last piece of noodle, which intrigued me because the extreme spiciness wasn't something I would ever look forward to having. But I could understand why - spicy food helps relieve stress. Making buldac-ghetti in a cafeteria isn't as easy as it seems, but the dish is a guaranteed success, so why not have it once in a while? (chuckles)

MH Many students have realized that the school meals during testing weeks are much more appetizing than those during regular school weeks. We jokingly call these "suicide-prevention meals." Do you purposely plan delicious meals during testing weeks, or is it just a peculiar coincidence?

I've always wondered how I can lessen the students' suffering during exam weeks. My solution was to make meals more appealing so students would come up to the cafeteria even during exam weeks instead of starving to study or substituting their dinner with instant noodles. Cafeteria food is supposed to support students with their hard work.

MH What are your foremost concerns when planning a monthly menu?

I prioritize nutrition over anything else. Then, I consider the students' preferences. Nutrition and taste do not necessarily call for a trade-off. I try to keep myself updated on the newest food trends through the Internet, but it would certainly help if students voice out their suggestions about the menu.

The One Who Gave Up Bacon

MH Hello, Ms. Seuk! This interview is aimed to gratify many curiosities about your eating habits. Is there any special occasion that made you determined to be a vegetarian?

I've been a vegetarian since I was 11. That was way back when phones had cords and rotary dials, and dragons roamed the earth. Before terms like "organic" and "free range" entered the average Joe's lexicon. I used to love meat. Then one day in 6th grade science class, I learned about factory farming, which is terrible for animals, terrible for human health, terrible for real farmers, terrible for planet Earth. My love for animals rivaled that of, say, 19th waver Chang Seo-Won, if you can believe it, so learning that every morsel of meat I'd ever savored had come from animals who were denied clean water, chemical-free food, the ability to walk around, a ray of sunshine, or a single kind touch transformed me into an animal rights activist who plastered her walls with posters of sad-eyed animals stuffed into tiny cages.

My sister told me I wouldn't be saving any pigs' lives because she'd just eat twice as much bacon. I think that's hilarious now. I, um, didn't back then.



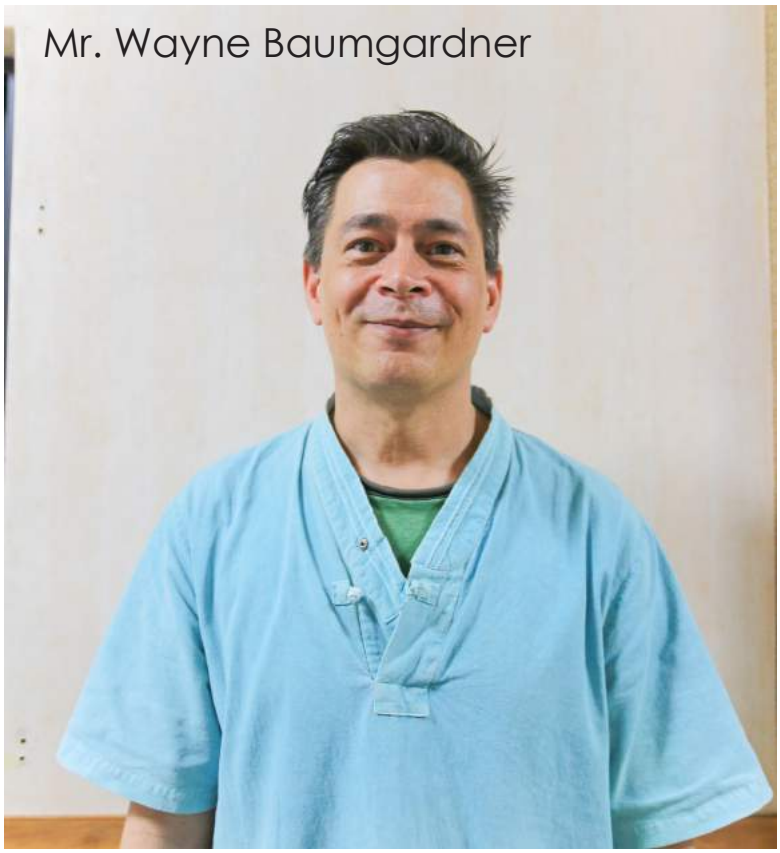
MH Being vegetarian is _____. Could you fill in the blanks for us?

Being vegetarian is a constant for me. Some vegetarians go back to eating meat. But I never will. It's just been too long. I'm still nostalgic for the memory of eating bacon — but the thought of actually eating it makes me nauseous.

MH Any last words on vegetables/vegetarianism/importance of a balanced diet, etc.?

If I were a 6th grader today, I probably wouldn't become vegetarian. It's easier to find foods now with fewer chemicals and less cruelty, if you care to. I don't think being vegetarian is "the right thing to do" for everyone. It's right for me. In fact, some people criticize me for being a fish-eating pescetarian — but we all do what we can to sate our appetites and our consciences. Just be a little more aware of the earth and its creatures. I totally understand if you don't want to give up bacon.

Does He Eat?



MH Hello, Mr. Baumgardner! We've often heard you say "I have no life" and wanted to know its extents. Could you tell us a bit about your eating habits? Do you ever eat?

Of course I eat! I mean, I'll eat something, some snacks lying about. I even take naps (pointing at a random pile of what seemed like mattresses)—

MH Right... But you're seldom seen in the cafeteria, so some students wonder if you ever have proper meals.

I don't like the lines, I don't like the elevators, and I certainly don't want to wait 20 minutes to get food that I might not like. Although I am thankful to the English meals posted on Facebook these days. Besides, if I eat at the cafeteria, I end up eating too much, and then I'm too tired for the rest of the day. And I prefer not to go the long way up to the cafeteria, which is pretty far from Dasan Hall. So you see, there's a number of reasons why I prefer home food. Well, during the APs, I got really bored, so I ate in the cafeteria. The teachers welcomed me saying, "You're back!"

MH Then you do you take any regular meals?

I have dinner every day. I prefer home food to the cafeteria, so I just eat snacks during the day and have dinner at home. I'm not starving, obviously. I mean, I love you guys, but not that much as to exchange my meals with my school work.

Fun Facts!

We present to you some interesting facts about the food we eat every day, coming directly from the school nutritionist Ms. Kim Min-Sun. Get ready to be surprised!

1. Though the quantity of leftover food varies greatly from day to day, for a typical meal it is a whopping ten times more than that of an average Korean high school!

2. The leftover food and honjeong bread are donated to the regional Food Bank, a Catholic organization which distributes the food to less fortunate people.

3. A KMLA student consumes over three times more meat than the average Korean high school student! Yet ironically, one of the most frequent demands from students is to increase the number of meat options in the menu.

MH Could you tell us a bit about your coffee intake?

(laughing) The thing is, I can't stand coffee. People seem to think I'm addicted to it, but I'm really don't enjoy it at all. I'm only drinking it for the caffeine. Like one or two pots a day, with 10 or so cups per pot (glancing at a coffee pot that looks like it has been a million years since it was last cleaned). I guess it is a bit much now that I think of it. I can't stand being tired though, except when I'm ready to sleep of course, so I'm only drinking coffee for that extra perk.

Chang Seo-Won, Cho Hae-Min
Senior feature writer, 19th Wave;
Junior feature writer, 20th Wave

20th Anniversary special interviews

Meeting Alumni



1st Interview

8th Wave Alumna Lim Su-Jin
"Life had more in store than just textbooks."

1. What kind of work are you currently involved in?

I work at the Asian headquarters of an American company called Ebates, situated in Singapore. It became a subsidiary company of Japan's largest electronic commerce corporation Rakuten in 2013. It has been three years since I joined the company, and I am currently working as the Director of Business Development of Ebates Asia.

Ebates is basically an online cashback website. When customers purchase products from foreign websites via Ebates, we provide cashback proportional to the amount purchased. Among Asian countries the majority of my duties are focused on South Korean purchases and businesses.

2. How has life at KMLA helped your career?

For the typical Korean high school student, 99% of one's effort is focused on enrolling into a good college. But at KMLA, I was able to experience much more than just studying. Certainly, we did that too, but I feel that students were less preoccupied with college. Life had more in store than just textbooks. I pondered upon what kind of path I wanted to take, my dreams and worries. In retrospect, what felt like monumental decisions were mostly "cute" concerns, but it was thanks to this process that I could endure the harsh competition at college to arrive at my current position.

KMLA students also learn how to supervise themselves. I believe this ability to be more important than intelligence. Especially when you go abroad, you often feel isolated in an environment where no one genuinely cares about you. Your family is miles away, college courses are hard, and it's difficult hunting for internships. You always have to be alert, striving to do better than the best, and it's only those with strong minds who complete the marathon. At KMLA, the art of self-supervision becomes part of your rhythm. It's really quite important.

2nd Interview

18th Wave Alumna Jeon Ha-Kyung
"I choose the path of an artist."

1. How have you been since graduating KMLA?

I'm just a freshman at college. To be more specific, I'm currently attending Korea National University of Arts, studying in the school of drama. I really like my school! Every department differs from one another, but in the department of directing dramas, I get to read well-crafted prose and meet superb writers, so my academic endeavors haven't stopped since leaving KMLA. We also have debate/presentation classes with small numbers of students.

2. What kind of dream do you wish to achieve now?

This is a very difficult question! I want to continue on with drama for the moment. My peers and seniors advise me to develop a career with stability. The sensible option would then be employment at the large, monopolistic corporations that dominate the Korean culture industry — but I choose the path of an artist. I don't sympathize with people who deprive the livelihoods of fellow artists.

Dreams are abstract, and people often fear them for their lack of concreteness. But I think dreams are better off that way! You could possibly create a new job through your goal, so don't worry about occupation when choosing a major. Jobs are merely means to keep you from starving. Also, don't be swayed by other's opinions; even if your dream is as small as tending a vegetable garden, that is an equally valuable dream.

Han Ji-Min
Junior feature writer, 20th Wave



Investigation Without Procedure

In KMLA, there exists a unique policy that divides the Student Council into three different branches. A feature that arises from this system is the Judicial Council's evidence investigation. The Student Code of Conduct states that the Judicial Council must uncover students' violations of school rules. This policy may seem a bit strange in that it allows and in fact forces students to investigate fellow students. This editorial deals with the process of the Judicial Council's evidence investigation and the boundary of its authority.

To first examine how the evidence investigation is usually held, the President of the 20th Judicial Council, Choi In-Hye, was interviewed. She explained that the members of the council meet together every Tuesday and go through the submitted final defending speeches carefully. The names on the speeches are erased before inspection for the sake of fairness. After taking note of what is to be investigated, the names are uncovered and the investigations begin. Processes include meeting related witnesses or the dorm parents.

The investigation system of the Judicial Council is meaningful in that it contributes to student autonomy, but it also has several limitations. The most significant limitation is that there is no systematic or organized manual of investigation. Although there does exist a guideline regarding formal procedures such as participatory trials on Wednesdays, there is no specific manual on investigations. Therefore the method and depth of investigation can vary greatly depending on the members of the judicial branch. This allows a higher possibility of subjectivity involved in the process. Add to this problem the fact that concrete evidence is often difficult to find during investigations, and less room for an objective and reasonable investigation remains. A detailed manual therefore seems necessary for an objective and fair investigation process.

Due to the lack of an organized procedure, there is also no specific limit to the authority that the investigation may have. Some students have felt pressured during the investigation process because there is no limit on the number of times the council can subject the defendants to questioning. Also, President of the 19th Judicial Council Hwang Jae-Won pointed out in an interview that there can be situations in which, due to the lack of concrete evidence, the Judicial Council relies upon suspicion and gut instinct instead. Systematic manuals on how to collect evidence, question witnesses, and run an investigation are necessary for the investigations of the Judicial Council to become more objective, fair, and reasonable.

"A detailed manual is necessary for an objective and fair investigation process."

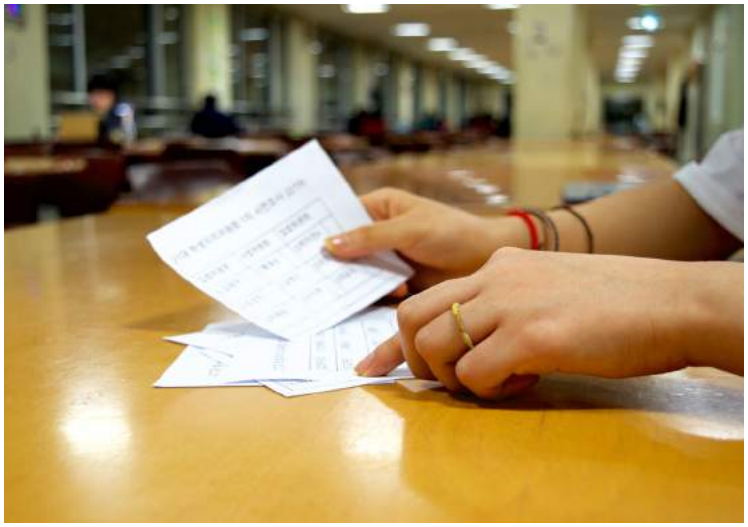
Yoo Han-Kyoung
Junior writer, 20th Wave

Lending an Ear to KMLA's Opinion

"We must use this controversy as a stepping stone for more fruitful discussion."

On February 19th a public opinion survey regarding the candidates for the 21st Student Council was conducted, and the result was announced on KMLA Online that night. However, the announcement was taken down the next day when the President of the Executive Council, 19th waver Koo Min-Suk, expressed his opposition to the survey on KMLA Forum.

His main argument was that "[the poll result] was influential enough to change the result of the real votes." The results were announced only a few days before the day of the actual election. Thus, many students might have received the impression that the results would not change and further discussion would be meaningless. Koo Min-Suk cited the Korean Public Offices Election Law, stating the Electoral Commission's authority to approve such polls and how public opinion surveys are not allowed after six days before the election.



However, the final election result showed that while the public opinion survey may have been influential, exactly what influence it had was a mystery. The actual election results did not mirror those of the survey. In fact, the poll failed to predict any of the Presidents of the three branches. 19th waver Ahn Se-Bin, head of the press that covered the election process and editor of this publication, stated, "As the result differs, it shows that the voters voted according their own conscience."

In addition, the six-days limit which Koo Min-Suk suggested was in fact not violated. The election was held on February 26th; therefore, no polls can be conducted starting from February 20th. However, the survey at KMLA was conducted on February 19th.

The authority of the Electoral Commission was also in question. It is true that Korean press need approval from the government to conduct such polls; however, in other countries such as the U.S. such permission is unnecessary. Thus the press argues, "The authority which Koo Min-Suk argued for is not absolute but debatable."

Nevertheless, it is undeniable that the poll was conducted quite roughly. The fact that such a poll was to be held was not known by anyone excluding the press before it occurred, making prior discussion of the survey impossible. Also, not all voters responded to the poll, so the poll was granted more credibility and influence that it should have been.

Even after this controversy, there is still not enough discussion concerning public opinion surveys. "Many seem to agree with the intent of the poll: raising awareness, motivating candidates and voters, and checking the electorate's response. Therefore, the question should be how to create a conducive environment for such surveys," Ahn Se-Bin asserted. As KMLAians pride ourselves on a functional student government, we must use this controversy as a stepping stone for more fruitful discussion that will hopefully lead to a better methodology for the next elections.

Jung Sang-Min
Junior writer, 20th Wave

English Only Policy: Here We Go, Again

January 28th, 2016: EOP promoters were given award points if they fulfilled their role for three days. Any student who saw an EOP promoter violating EOP could replace them as the next EOP promoter.

February 14th, 2016: EOP promoter policy was stopped abruptly for an entire week.

February 21st, 2016: EOP promoters were required to go through pre-training. They had to write diaries every day and send it to the Department of EOP.

March 7th, 2016: EOP promoters could now send students to court for EOP violation. The changed rules were uploaded on KMLA Online.

Ideologies change, circumstances change, and public opinion changes. Thus, it is natural that policies also shift accordingly. That, however, does not justify radical shifts without the consent of the main stakeholders.

Ms. Hwang So-Hee, the teacher who administrates all EOP related issues in the Office of Student Guidance, stated, "In terms of the Student Code of Conduct, there are standard procedures. However, EOP is a matter of Articles of Student Autonomy. This is just like enforcement ordinances made by the departments of our country instead of parliament. I feel that that is the role that departments play in our school."

Regardless of modern day policies, though, any significant changes of school rules, even by departments, have always been up for question. When the Department of Food and Nutrition implemented an innovative quota system in 2015, they had to go through a Class Council vote in order for such change to happen. Mr. Kim Myung-Soon, Director of the Office of Student Guidance, said in an interview, "Currently we are giving students the fullest autonomy possible regarding specific policies on how to keep EOP." It remains to be a question, however, whether this autonomy is for the whole student body or reserved only for the Department of EOP.

Ms. Hwang added later on in the interview, "I feel that the changes in the EOP system were too rapid this time." Changes in EOP regulations were problemetic because they concerned a value debate on which the students' opinions were scarcely listened to. Despite the fact that the EOP promoter policy was implemented as a "carrot" rather than a "stick," promoters could now send people to court, serving as a "stick". No one had any say regarding whether they wanted a "carrot" or a "stick."

> "When a policy is enforced without taking public opinion into account... policymakers can insist upon a philosophy of their own."

Any form of change without the consent of students cannot be deemed positive, regardless of the positive effects. Such convention could always open room for dogmatic regulations, violating the rights of students as well as the point of student autonomy.



EOP happens to be one of the founding philosophies of KMLA. However, when time and trial have proved its policies somewhat dysfunctional, perhaps we must revisit and debate the reality of this major pillar of the school. When a policy is enforced without taking public opinion into account, that in itself means that policymakers can insist upon a philosophy of their own.

"Every time we take a vote, more than half of the students agree with EOP," people often say. That does not mean that students agree with every single policy promoted for EOP, nor does it mean that students agree with the directions of the legislative council or the department of EOP.

Policies must change, but only when we know about how ideologies and circumstances have changed. It is perhaps time that EOP opens itself to students once again, asking for opinions. Not just yes-or-no opinions, but a large spectrum of opinions.

Han Ye-Joo
Junior writer, 20th Wave

The People We Can't Vote For

Currently, students with academic probation, a history of suspension, or fifteen or more penalty points are immediately excluded from the Student Council elections. Throughout the years, this regulation has turned down several students with profound interest in the Student Council. Due to this problem, the 20th legislative council proposed to abolish the restriction during the Assembly of Representatives. As the assembly progressed, class representatives debated upon the purpose and legitimacy of the regulation.

For the academic probation portion, most students agreed that the purpose was to encourage failing students to study by restricting their extracurricular activities. However, the regulation sets a dangerous precedent that enforces the belief that grades are simply more important than other meaningful activities. KMLA is unique in that it grants students much freedom when it comes to both academic and personal development. If too much of this freedom is taken away, KMLA might slowly lose its unique and cherished characteristic, and herein lies the danger of this regulation.

Advocates of the suspension portion of the regulation argue that candidates should serve as role models for the other students. This responsibility is indisputable; however, a suspension does not automatically make someone a bad role model. There are numerous reasons why students are suspended. Some common reasons include being caught for computer violation multiple times or bringing a pencil case to a test. In some cases, these actions are carried out without malicious intent. Instead, most are simple mistakes that could be made by anyone. This regulation has its flaws in that it cannot objectively evaluate a student's ability to serve as a role model.

Compared to the others, the penalty point portion has greater justification. Penalty points can serve as an objective meter to judge the diligence of a candidate. KMLA students need to be meticulous and hardworking in order to avoid penalty points because lax actions such as playing during self-study hours or waking up late during weekends lead directly to penalty points. Having low penalty points also shows the unlikelihood of the candidate's impeachment during his or her term. The loss of a member can be a critical blow to the Student Council as it adds more work to each member, burdening their already-busy schedule. To insure that the Student Council works efficiently, the penalty point restriction may be necessary.

The legitimacy of specific portions of the regulation, though, is trivial compared to the biggest but most ignored problem: the regulation's existence itself.

> "In a healthy democracy, it is up to the voters to judge if the candidate is up for the job or not."

No matter what the specific portions of the regulation may be, the premise underlying it is that a student's capability to become part of the student council is based upon how the student acted in the past. The system functions on the judgmental premise that a person will always be the same, and that they can never change the habits of his or her past. This leads to several eager and quite capable candidates losing even a chance to be on the election ballot. In a healthy democracy, it is up to the voters to judge if the candidate is up for the job or not, and that should be the case in KMLA as well. The 20th legislative council's efforts to loosen such regulations are laudable, yet the road to meaningful change has only just begun. It is time for the student body to turn our eyes to the people we can't vote for, and ask why, so that the how can change as well.

Hwang Chul-Soon
Junior Writer, 20th Wave

Deserve to Serve?

odd

2016 Literary Contest Prize-Winner

What's So Odd About Odd Numbers?



uzdho

This March, Minjok Herald held an in-school literary contest for freshmen. One of the three prompts was "What's so odd about odd numbers?" which was inspired by the infamous 2014 UChicago essay prompt. The following essay submitted on this topic won the grand prize for this year's literary contest.

We refer to many things as odd in our world. People who eat alone in diners can be considered odd. Numbers such as nine, eighty-one, or even 345,671,278,903 are considered odd. If the dorm parent catches you playing computer games while eating ramen but doesn't give you a violation, and instead joins you, that would be considered extremely odd.

Before going any deeper into what "odd numbers" are, or how significant they are, a proper understanding of the term is necessary since so many various meanings may cause confusion.

The first dictionary definition of odd that comes up: different from what is usual or expected. The modern word "odd" has numerous other meanings such as "not divisible by two", "leftovers", "irregularity", and "separation from a pair or set". But mathematical or not, these numerous meanings can be traced back to the Indo-European root uzdho, meaning pointing upwards.

Inspired by the idea of a vertical pointing object, speakers of Old Norse modified this term to a new word, Oddi, which refers to a triangle — the simplest pointed object in geometrical terms. A triangle with a long point like an arrow head could be considered to have two paired angles and a third that stands alone.

Over time, oddi began to refer to something that wasn't matched or paired, like my socks in the laundry bin. Old Norse also adapted the word to symbolize a number indivisible by two. And odda mathr, the odd man, was used to describe that unpaired man whose vote would break a tie in a 1:1 ratio situation. Though English never used the word "odd" to mean triangle, they borrowed the concept of odd numbers and the odd man. And finally, in the 16th century, the notion of the odd number gave rise to our modern meaning of being peculiar, not bound in social norms.

Being odd is not something to be ashamed of or embarrassed about. A lot of people try to hide their true selves, accept social norms, and blend in. Being afraid to go on a different path from others is natural, for humans are social beings. However, the courage to pursue such individual passion and being able to say or do what you want is necessary for a more satisfying life. Odd numbers seem to be people who don't back down because of the trends. Odd numbers stay odd, and are indivisible by two unlike even numbers.

Abraham Lincoln didn't care what other people thought and became a source of innovation in how people viewed the concept of race. The people of the late 19th century thought the Wright brothers were crazy to attempt flight in such a manner. Not a lot of adults who saw Steve Jobs drop out of college would have expected him to become the innovator and main influence of the computer revolution. The main reason I decided to come to KMLA, as many students would agree, is its wide variety of classes and activities, which ensure students access to deep studies in their respective fields, whether it should be computer graphics, linguistics, or even creating music. I myself have come to learn this idea while signing up for school clubs, even though it has only been a couple of weeks since I came here.

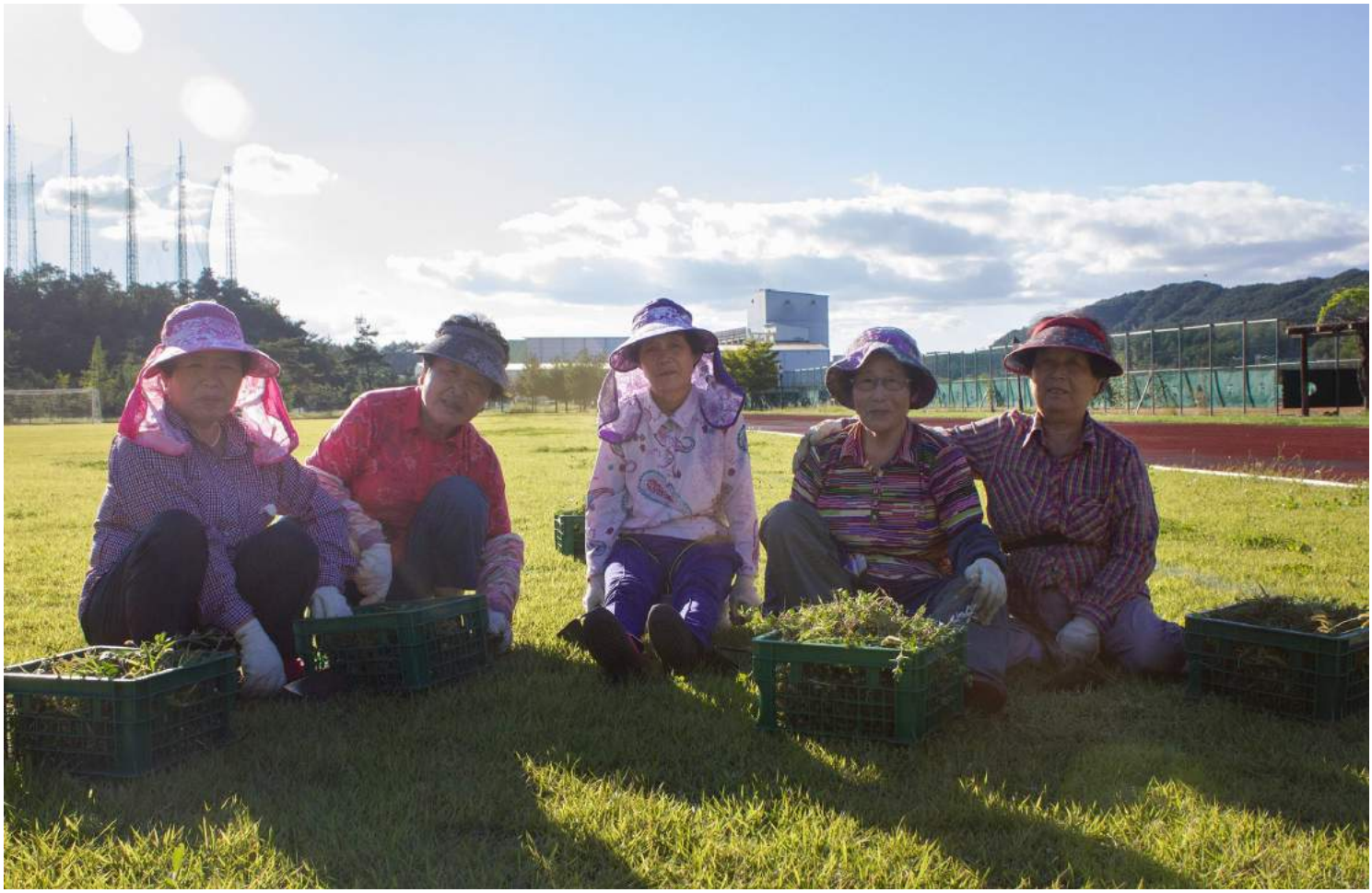
People are afraid of standing out from others. Maslow described this in one of the hierarchy of needs as esteem or being respected by peers. However, innovation did not start from conformity. Great leaders who brought change did not start that way. Respected people that are unforgettable did not either. Paradigm shifts never start with normality. Staying in the comfort of a group like even numbers means not going against the group. Going against popular opinion, even in the face of possible rejection by society is what makes being odd significant.

At the end of the day, odd numbers are odd indeed. They are different from others, they stand out, and at times they may be outcasts. But they are at the same time the power of change in society, the propeller for paradigm shifts. Just as the original concept uzdho meant, odd numbers point upwards, towards change and innovation. Odd numbers are odd, but even numbers aren't. And I find it odd when someone wants to be an even number.

Ahn Tae-Gyu
21st Waver

odda mathr

Humans of Minsa



HoM Until when do you work here? Are you coming again next year?

"Today's the fifth day and it will be over this week."

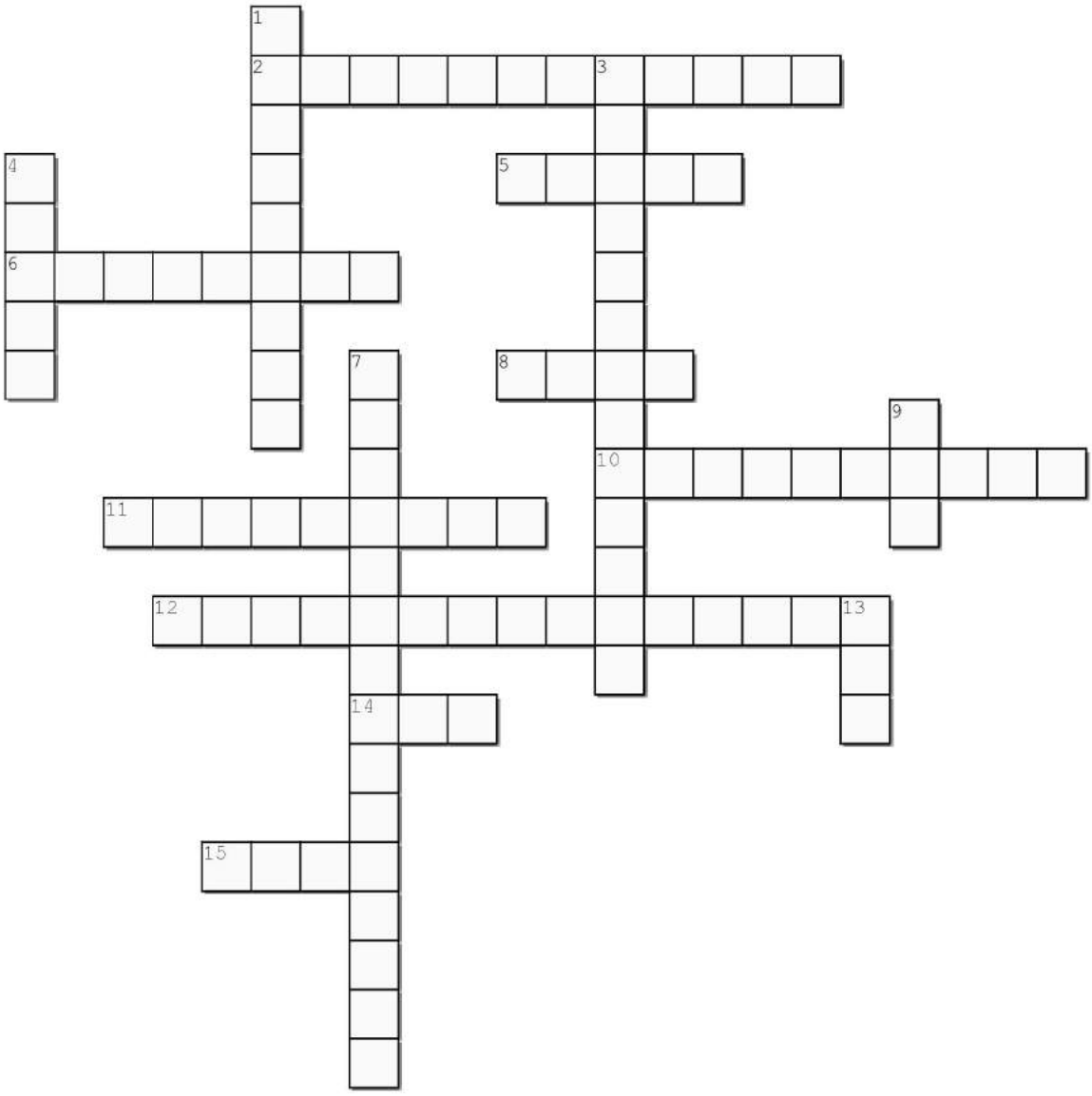
"We've been coming here for years now. We'll come again next spring too!"

"The students here are so polite — every single one of them greets us as we pass by. It makes us want to reciprocate in the same way."

HoM The students are curious about you guys; is it okay if we take your picture?

"Really? But who would want to see us? And why take pictures of old, withered hags? (haha) This time when you go home, try showing your mom our pictures and she'll be like: 'I can't believe people like this still exist today!'" (wry smile)

Crossword



Across

2. KMLA's school flower
5. you better get a girls' sword for this
6. Ms. Hwang So-Hee's favorite philosopher
8. the tragic dormitory door color
10. what Mr. Hwang Hyung-Ju calls students when they don't use staplers
11. former job of Mr. Kim Byeong-Moo (day dorm parent)
12. 20, 40, 60
14. a club named after a chemical compound
15. Hola _____!

Down

1. the vocabulary book hated by all 10th graders
3. something you should never take two of
4. the number of Mr. Neil Tweedie's children
7. the highest grossing movie of all time
9. the number of Wi-Fi routers in the cafeteria
13. when student court is happening here, you know it's bad



(n.)
talk or stories about someone that may not be true

"SCUTTLEBUTT"